

YOUTH SPEAK...

Let's hear from our youth...

This edition starts what we hope will become regular participation by youth of the Diocese of San Jose in the pages of The Valley Catholic. Jim Pham, father of two children, whose family are active parishioners at St. Francis of Assisi Parish in San Jose, submitted an essay by his 13-year-old son.

Pham asked his children, and a niece, to write their faith stories for the Year of Faith. Sean Pham writes about his beliefs regarding some serious topics. At their parish the young people are actively involved as altar servers, Eucharistic ministers and ushers.

Jim Pham is also actively involved with the local Vietnamese Catholic Community.

This I believe

***By Sean Pham
13 years old***

[Callout Box]: 'We should try to protect other people's life even if we don't like them.'

What do you believe? Everyone has something to believe in. Not everyone may agree with you, and what you believe in may not be true. This I believe: a) the meaning of life, b) abortion is wrong, and c) everyone has the right to live.

What is the meaning of life? Life is given to us to live on earth, our home. Why are our parents living in the United States of America? Our parents are here to escape communism or seek a new life. In some countries, such as Vietnam and China, parents are forced to abort their child and limit family size.

In America, the American government protects our right to life. To every person, your life is the most valuable thing. We should try to protect other people's life even if we don't like them. We should be thankful that we live in America where our life is protected. We should also feel sorry for those who live in places where the government puts limits to life.

Why are humans aborting babies? Some may say they are not ready to have a child or that a fetus is not human. Even if you are not ready to have a child you should accept you have one and raise it to be a good person. I believe that a fetus is a child and deserves to live.

As humans we should follow the natural law that shows us the way to live like human beings. Abortion breaks natural law; killing an adult or infant is wrong. Why are aborting infants when they have not done anything wrong?

What would you do if a person killed a member of your family? I would forgive the person and if he was sentenced to death I would defend him to save his life because he is still a human being. As humans we have a second chance to do what is right. We learn from our mistakes and prevent them from happening again.

There is always a reason why a person is bad, perhaps because their parents are not there to teach them bad and good, they got bad influence, or they may have had a mental breakdown that made them crazy.

If killing people is bad, then why are U.S. soldiers killing terrorists in Iraq and Afghanistan? We are there because terrorists are killing innocent people and we are there to defend the rights of citizens in both countries.

I believe that everyone has the right to live. Abortion is preventing a baby to grow up and do something extraordinary. If someone kills a member of your family you should not take revenge but you should defend their life and forgive them. Everyone has the right to live and it is of the most important right of all.

YOUTH & YOUNG ADULTS THE VALLEY CATHOLIC

YOUTH SPEAK...

Let's hear from our youth...

This edition starts what we hope will become regular participation by youth of the Diocese of San Jose in the pages of *The Valley Catholic*. Jim Pham, father of two children, whose family are active parishioners at St. Francis of Assisi Parish in San Jose, submitted an essay by his 13-year-old son.

Pham asked his children, and a niece, to write their faith stories for the Year of Faith. Sean Pham writes about his beliefs regarding some serious topics. At their parish the young people are actively involved as altar servers, Eucharistic ministers and ushers.

Jim Pham is also actively involved with the local Vietnamese Catholic Community.

This I believe

By Sean Pham
13 years old

What do you believe? Everyone has something to believe in. Not everyone may agree with you, and what you believe in may not be true. This I believe: a) the meaning of life, b) abortion is wrong, and c) everyone has the right to live.

What is the meaning of life? Life is given to us to live on earth, our home. Why are our parents living in the United States of America? Our parents are here to escape communism or seek a new life. In some countries, such as Vietnam and China, parents are forced to abort their child and limit family size.

In America, the American government protects our right to life. To every person, your life is the most valuable thing. We should try to protect other people's life even if we don't like them. We should be thankful that we live in America where our life is protected. We should also feel sorry for those who live in places where the government puts limits to life.

Why are humans aborting babies? Some may say they are not ready to have a child or that a fetus is not human. Even if you are not ready to have a child you should accept you have one and raise it to be a good person. I believe that a fetus is a child and deserves to live.

As humans we should follow the natural law that shows us the way to live like human beings. Abortion breaks natural law; killing an adult or infant is wrong. Why are we aborting infants when they have not done anything wrong?

What would you do if a person killed a member of your family? I would forgive the person and if he was sentenced to death I would defend him to save his life because he is still a human being. As humans we have a second chance to do what is right. We learn from our mistakes and prevent them from happening again.

There is always a reason why a person is bad, perhaps because their parents are not there to teach them bad and good, they got bad influence, or they may have had a mental breakdown that made them crazy.

If killing people is bad, then why are U.S. soldiers killing terrorists in Iraq and Afghanistan? We are there because terrorists are killing innocent people and we are there to defend the rights of citizens in both countries.

I believe that everyone has the right to live. Abortion is preventing a baby to grow up and do something extraordinary. If someone kills a member of your family you should not take revenge but you should defend their life and forgive them. Everyone has the right to live and it is of the most important right of all.

There is no hope. That is why I like yourselves to be we not be robbed strength is a grace, carries us forward heaven."

Staff writer for Catholic U.S. Conference of

Comments readers

c invites young nents regarding ail comments; s; include full hone number tted comments

@dsj.org

3

ber 1-3

ber 8-10

Original Newspaper Article Scan